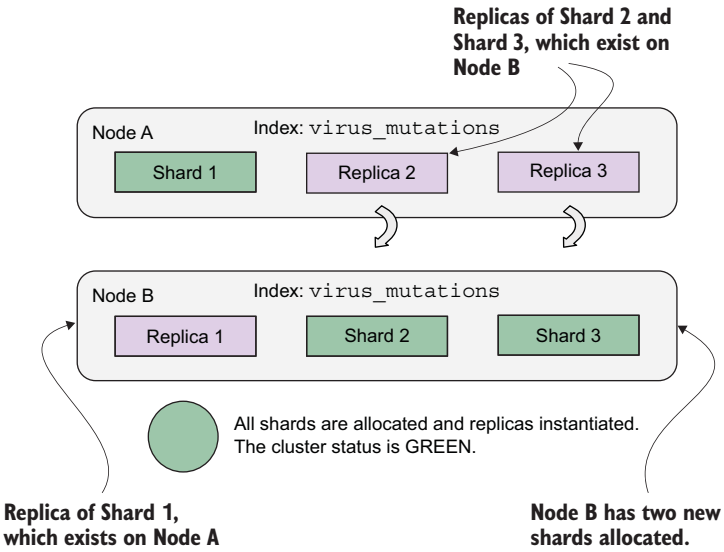


Figure 3.12 Happy days! All shards and replicas are allocated.

The primary and replica shards are all assigned and ready. The cluster status is now GREEN.

Rebalancing shards

There's always a risk of hardware failures. In our example, what happens if Node A crashes? If Node A disappears, Elasticsearch readjusts the shards by promoting Replica 1 to Shard 1, because Replica 1 is a copy of Shard 1 (see Figure 3.13).

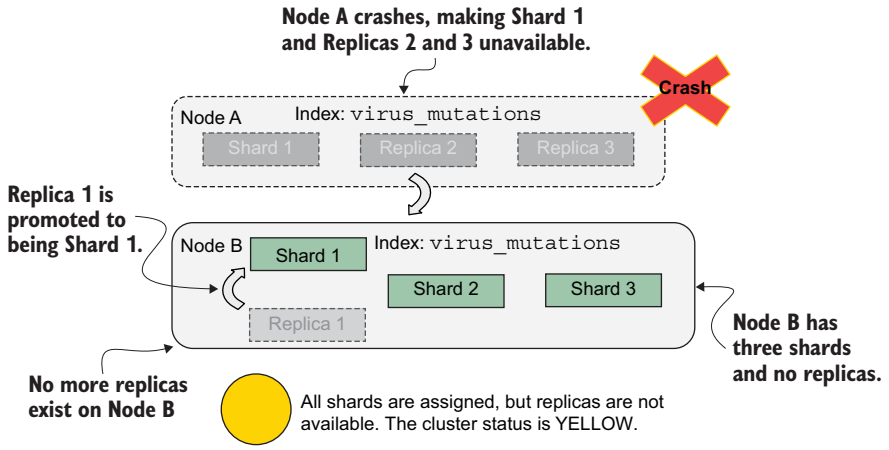


Figure 3.13 Replicas are lost (or promoted to shards) when a node crashes.